

Sit down and take all kinds of notes. Become familiar with your objectives. Write about your qualifications. If there are any other people involved in your venture, write about their qualifications too. Special sells, so let them know what is so unique about you and your goals. Let them know that what you have to offer is unlike anything else. Be honest about the challenges that you foresee in the future, and let them know of the ways in which you will meet those challenges. Get all the details down on paper, and don't worry about making it sound brilliant yet. For now, just get everything out on paper. Once you do, you'll feel really good going forward. You know what they say: knowledge is power.

Show It

The guys reading these applications want to know why they should be cutting you a check. Make it easy for them. When you sit down to write, make a decision. Make a decision to infuse your application with energy and enthusiasm. Be passionate about what you want, whether it's money for child care services or money to start your very own business. Passion is an exciting thing – it gets people interested in you!

Write It

Now comes the easy part: the writing. Since you know what you're talking about, and you're prepared to enthusiastically show it, the writing should be a breeze. Don't worry about getting it perfect the first time around. You can always go back and edit later. I know there are some people who are intimidated by facing a blank page, but think about it this way: nothing is ever set in stone until you're ready for it to be. You know what it is you want. Just go for it. Write it. Worry about the other stuff later. These foundations and agencies make it so easy too, because their applications guide you through every step. Take each step one at a time, and get it done!

Edit It

Once you're done with the writing, then comes the editing. Sometimes it's hard to be objective about your own writing, so grab a friend or the guy sitting next to you in the cafe, and ask them if they'll read your grant proposal for you. Tell them to look out for typos and